JUSTIN GONZALES

Toronto, ON | gonzales.justin.edward@gmail.com
linkedin.com/in/justin-edward-gonzales/

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Commercial strategy and client advisory professional with 4+ years of experience leading integrated initiatives for national brands. Own end-to-end FY26 and FY27 planning and delivery across a ~$30M annual portfolio, combining strategic partnerships, data-informed investment decisions, cross-functional project leadership and practical AI innovation.

CORE STRENGTHS

Commercial & Client Strategy • End-to-End Project Leadership • Strategic Partnerships & Innovation • Portfolio & Budget Management • Audience & Competitive Analytics • Executive Stakeholder Engagement • AI-Enabled Process Improvement

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SPARK FOUNDRY CANADA | Publicis Media Canada

Senior Media Planner | *March 2025 – Present*

- Led end-to-end FY26 and FY27 national media planning across Coors Light, Molson, Miller Lite and Madri, owning briefing, strategy development, project timelines, cross-functional coordination, executive presentations and final delivery.
- Direct strategic planning for approximately $30M in annual media investment across four national brands, shaping channel strategy, budget allocation, campaign timing and performance measurement.
- Advise marketing directors and senior brand stakeholders, translating commercial objectives, audience research and competitive insights into strategic recommendations and investment decisions.
- Spearheaded pitching, development and execution of strategic media partnerships, including Molson's The Amazing Race Canada integration and Miller Lite's Blue Jays Territory podcast partnership, connecting brands with relevant audiences.
- Partnered with the Group Account Director and Media Director to co-lead media strategy, investment planning, partner coordination and cross-functional delivery for Coors Light's Home DeCoors campaign.
- Developed audience- and occasion-based FY27 planning frameworks using consumer research, competitive intelligence and campaign performance insights to identify growth opportunities and guide investment strategy.
- Built a custom Microsoft Copilot agent to centralize client and planning knowledge, support presentation reviews and critically evaluate media strategies; shared agent-building practices with colleagues.
- Selected for Publicis Media Canada's inaugural AI training cohort, applying AI tools to improve documentation, communication and planning workflows.
- Mentored four junior planners and coordinators on strategic planning, analytical tools, client management and professional development.

Media Planner | *July 2024 – February 2025*

- Independently owned media planning for the 6 Pints craft beer portfolio and served as lead planner for Heineken, Sol, Birra Moretti and other brands, managing strategy, investment recommendations and client coordination.
- Led research and audience planning for the Canadian launch of Heineken Silver, translating market insights into actionable national campaign recommendations.
- Worked across planning, activation and analytics teams to coordinate execution; contributed as a credited planner to recognized campaigns including Molson's Paid Through Parents and Birra Moretti's Nonna Supper Club.

Assistant Media Planner | *September 2023 – June 2024*

- Supported a Media Planner, Supervisor and Account Director across Signet, Miele, Molson Coors and Heineken Canada, contributing audience research, channel recommendations and performance analysis.
- Assisted with client onboarding, campaign workflows, cross-team deliverables and reporting processes under senior team guidance.

Programmatic Account Coordinator — Apex Exchange, Publicis Media Canada | *July 2022 – August 2023*

- Supported campaign execution, optimization and performance analysis for national and global clients including Starbucks, Stellantis, Epson and Visa.
- Synthesized campaign results and emerging trends into client-facing reporting and actionable insights; coordinated digital activation across multiple platforms.
- Managed campaign administration, financial reconciliation and data accuracy in Prisma across multiple client accounts.

SELECTED CAMPAIGNS & PROFESSIONAL RECOGNITION

- Molson — Paid Through Parents: Credited media planner on the campaign recognized with a 2025 Grand Clio (Partnerships & Collaborations) and One Show Bronze Pencil; campaign-level recognition shared across the broader team.
- Birra Moretti — Nonna Supper Club: Credited media planner on the activation recognized at Les Cas d'Or Montréal in 2025, including Jury Prize and Event Activation honours.
- Coors Light — Home DeCoors: Contributed to strategy, investment planning and cross-functional execution of an integrated national campaign alongside senior agency leadership.

EDUCATION & ACADEMIC RECOGNITION

SHERIDAN COLLEGE | Pilon School of Business

Post-Graduate Certificate, Advertising Account Management

Margaret Brown Byron Award — Selected by program leadership for passion, enthusiasm and professionalism, with strong academic standing.

UNIVERSITY OF TORONTO | St. George Campus

Bachelor of Kinesiology

J. Harry Ebbs Achievement Award — Recognition for significant academic improvement and excellence.

ANALYTICS, PLATFORMS & TOOLS

Analytics & Research: Google Analytics, GWI, comScore MyMetrix, comScore MediaMetrix, Telmar

Advertising & Operations: DV360, Amazon DSP, Xandr DSP, Yahoo DSP, Prisma, Print Toolkit

AI & Productivity: Microsoft Copilot, custom Copilot agents, AI-assisted knowledge management and workflow optimization; Google Workspace, Microsoft Office Suite